FLORENCE. In Florence are two prisons. In the great prison Palazzo degl' Otto, were only twenty prisoners. Six of them were in the secret chambers, which are twenty-one strong rooms. None of the prisoners were in irons. They had mattresses to lie on. Their bread was good. In the torture-chamber, there was a machine for decollation, which prevents that repetition of the stroke which too often happens when the axe is used.

LEGHORN. The slaves in the fortress appeared healthy and well; better, as the old keeper remarked, since they have lain on shore. Galleys or hulks ought to be the punishment only for the most atrocious crimes. Each prisoner had a ring round one leg; but when they go out to work, a chain is riveted to two prisoners. Here were seven pontons to clear the harbour; but the weather, when I was there, being stormy, they could not be worked. There were forty-seven slaves employed at the new Lazaretto, which is a noble spacious building, with different apartments for officers and their men to perform quarantine, and large warehouses for the cargoes of their ships.[1]

The prisoners are condemned to labour, for thirty, twenty, ten, or seven years, or for a shorter term, according to the nature of their crimes; and are chiefly employed on the public works. They are sent out every morning, under a guard of soldiers, and are chained two and two together, with a chain of about eighteen pounds weight. An hour's relaxation is allowed them at breakfast, and two hours in the afternoon: and at an hour before sunset, they are reconducted to the prison, and must be well searched by the keepers, to prevent their having anything concealed: and two hours after sunset, they are ordered to go quietly to rest. When they are employed on the works by his Royal Highness, they are paid two crazzies (about three halfpence) a day; but if employed by other persons, they are paid four or six crazzies, according to the nature of the work. At daybreak, the turnkeys ring the bell to awake them: and a report is made by them to the keepers, if any have been guilty of irregularities during the night. Their daily allowance is a loaf of thirty ounces, which is made two-thirds of flour, and one-third of bran, and soup made from four ounces of peas boiled in water, with salt and oil. On each of the two Easter holidays they are allowed a pound of meat, and three ounces of rice. Every two years they have a coat of grey cloth, a waistcoat

[1] I wish some future traveller would give us plans of this Lazaretto, and that at Ancona and other places, as they might suggest some useful alterations in the construction of our hospitals and other public buildings.

of red cloth, and a red cap; every year a pair of shoes; and every six months a shirt, and a pair of drawers or breeches. Their drawers are shifted once a month, their shirts every week. For lodging, they have a mattress filled with straw, and a coverlet: the straw is changed, and kept in good order. If one attempts to desert, and be taken before sunset, he must wear a ring, and a chain of eighteen pounds weight; and he must pay half his future earnings, till it amounts to a zechin, to those that apprehended him.[1] If they who are condemned for five years, desert, when retaken their term again commences: and for repeated desertions, they are more severely punished, and sometimes tortured.

The chaplain must instruct the prisoners.

In the hospital there must be all proper provisions for the sick and infirm, viz. veal, mutton, rice, fine bread, broth, good wine, etc. A physician attends, and the diet and medicines must be according to his prescription. On entering, the patients have clean linen, shirts, night-caps, and clothes. And the keepers and turnkey must examine their victuals and soup, to see that they be good, and that the quantity be according to the physician's orders.[2]

ROME. At the great prison at Rome, called the New Prison, at the back of which runs the Tiber, on a stone tablet over the door, is this inscription:

JUSTITIÆ ET CLEMENTIÆ
SECURIORI AC MELIORI REORUM CUSTODIÆ
NOVUM CARCEREM
INNOCENTIUS X PONT. MAX.
POSUIT
ANNO DOMINI
MDCLV.

To Justice and Clemency,
For the more secure and better custody of criminals,
Pope Innocent X erected this New Prison
In the year of our Lord
1655.

On the ground-floor; on one side are the slaves for the galleys at Civita-vecchia: on the other side is a sort of cook's shop,

[1] A zechin is about 9s. 3d.

[2] In Tuscany during the ten years preceding 1765 there were 3076 in prison for debt, 704 for petty offences, 210 condemned to the galleys, 17 executed, 5 branded. This punishment of branding was abolished by the Grand Duke Leopold. In the four years preceding 1769 there was no capital punishment.